Life of a Loud Mime

February 2026

WHAT IS THIS?

In what it seems like a flagellant joke, I decided to start a self-made newspaper-styled montly report of my life. Because my perilous writing skills are only second to my ability to artistically design stuff; so this might be the best chance I have to remind myself of how much I suck at things. And because self-deprecating attitudes are quite common nowadays, I will also allow some of my close friends to remind me of my gruesome skills by sharing these pages with them.

DECORATING HOUSE

February started with a few trips to the local Ikea; as I **a)** accidentally bought the wrong closet box, **b)** blamed Ikea for the mistake, **c)** let the custom service fix that, before finally **d)** realize I actually fucked up; in this order. This wave of new internal decoration actually started in October -- as I, just coming home from my trip in Spain, gained an abrupt need to improve the artificial lights of my appartement. This time I proceeded to buy a few closets, after I've been explained that they serve as a better place to store my stuff rather than the ground floor. While this might seems like a mere mondane and regular activity, buying fornitures for my appartement actually marks a more important step. To me, it is a small yet important commitment towards Ghent and Belgium as a home. Last year June, as I came back from my period in London, I realized how impactful the place I live in is for me. Naturally, that started a sequence of questions and anxious thoughts that made me consider many options regarding my future -- including leaving the country after my PhD. Since then, it really felt like a journey for me to cope with all those thoughts; leading me to the discovery of amazing writers and ideas, but also brutally exposing my weakness and eventually making myself very hard to get along. In fact, I often think of my last 12 months as an in-debt period of time, as I probably drained way more energies to the people around me than what I could give back.
Nonetheless, life now bought me to the purchase of capitalistic pieces of fornitures, with the idea in mind that I will stick around here for a little longer, and I (probably) won't make anything particularly stupid regarding my future and my finances. You realize you probably have something messed up in your brain when you over-philosophize over simple actions such as buying a small closet at Ikea.

New closet.
Imagine all of that stuff, but on the ground. That is how much my brain cope with messy environments.

Selfie with my colleagues.
Hard to believe these 4 guys are soon to become PhD given how little serious they can be.

Smiley face.
I got blessed by an insect with a smiley face in its wings. Nice :)

New plant for my home.
I started a new effort to popolate my house with vegetations. This one has to be one of the prettiest I ever bought.

Making arancine with a moderate hunger.
I joined an original sicilian arancine workshop with Irene's family. Fun stuff, but I'm more fan of the eating rather than the making.

We battle Giants forever
They'll always be Giants, that's true
Thank God it's my favorite thing to do

We Battle Giants -- Bandits on the Run

SURFING MY ROOTS

Last week of February, I flought back to Italy for a few days. While these trips are now way less painful than what they were 1-2 years ago, it's still interesting to go back 'home'. I came out with the expression of "surfing my roots": carefully scratching the surface of my origins and riding whatever wave I get from them, without fully swimming in them. A few weeks ago I randomly rediscovered a song sang in Bologna dilect: 'Gig' by Andrea Mingardi. It's a song of outstanding simplicity that raise gigantic feelings of childhood nostalgia. Songs like this remind me of how impactful that culture is on me, but yet struggle to identify in it.
Reality is, that land is soaked with fathomless pain for me. Since I moved in Ghent, all the painful things of my life felt geographically positioned there; while in Belgium I was building -- and discovering -- a new, exciting, and whole life. It took so damn long for me to step back in Modena without feeling a staggering feeling of fear and sadness choking my throat and stomach. And to be honest, I also fled much of my pain by simply avoiding the place and blinding myself with all that was going well in my life. Ultimately, that place is now not the same. Despite it being pretty much the same, loads has changed in relation to my life, and I've lost so much there since I moved here. As for everything in life, it's just a matter of letting changes flow, and accept the new dynamics with all around us. As for today, I still enjoy the simple conversation in strict dialect I hear in upstate 'Emilian' bars, the warm energy I feel everytime I hug my beloved nonna, and the sadness of a dear place that changed, but not within my pace and vision.

Self-made latte art.
Getting better at this! But after 5-6 days of good latte arts, I kinda forgot how I did that lol.

Ghirlandina in Modena.
During sunny days, this will always be a gorgeous place to be for me.

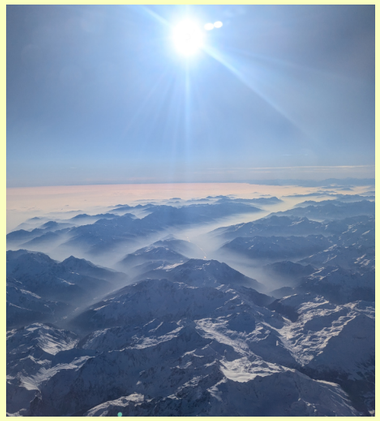
VEGANISM AND LIFE PURPOSES

While staying in Italy, I met my friend Chiara as she was participating in a vegan activism event in the city center of Modena. While it reminded me of how much I personally find majority of modern activism to be so filled with incompetence, it also released a new wave of thoughts on the topic of veganism; as my friend reminded me that my actions -- even the ones I perform rarely -- have an impact in the globe, and that meat and dairy consumption -- regardeless of my frequency -- equates the brutal act of killing animals. And even though I still won't let go of the comforting consumption of animal products today, I -- as everyone else -- should well visualize and understand the effect of that. My values and morales are clear, and I need to -- at the very least -- suffer from the hypocrisy of my actions whenever I put food comfort over the life of an animal. After the activism event, while talking with Chiara, I realized how important the topic is for her. That activism is not just about finding an activity to fill her time or trying to make a contribution to society, but rather a more existential need to fight the oppressive thoughts that make existence unbearable. I can't help but feeling deeply proud of her efforts in the cause; but also, that conversation reminded myself of how purpose is essential for humans. Of how ideals and values ultimately guide humans to great achivements, and of how passion and personal envolvement is crucial to self realization.

Fall to sleep,
Hold on to something sweet
It's the onlt place where you can hide
From your own conscious mind

Fall to Sleep -- The Wild Reeds

Pizza from La Smorfia, Nonantola.
Every trip back to Italy entails a carbs marathon. A stop to my favorite pizzeria in the world can't be missed.



The Alps.
Nice :)

MY MUSICAL MONTH WRAPPED

- Lisa Never Wanted To Be Famous -- Cory Wong, Theo Katzman
- Sono pazzo -- MOBRICI, Fulminacci
- Fall to Sleep -- The Wild Reeds
- We Battle Giants -- Bandits on the Run
- Enter the Jungle -- Ezra Collective, COLORS

DISCLAIMER :)

This text has been entirely written by humans. Any generative AI has been intenionally avoided. The natural consequence of this choice is the raising of imperfections all over the document. Imperfections are among the most human things I know; and they surely are a pure indication of my deepest and core being. In a world where technology is taking over all of our human functions, it is our own responsibility to step back and enjoy the slow, dull process of creating things by ourselves.